

The Reason I Jump

Fifty-eight answers from a nonspeaking boy, mapped into three movements.

MOVEMENT I Please Listen *How he reaches us — and what the outside view gets wrong*

01

The Alphabet Grid

He speaks by pointing to letters, not with his voice.

02

Why Speech Fails

The reply forms, then vanishes before he can say it.

03

A Pool of Dots

Repeated questions are memory finding its way back.

04

Don't Read Us From Outside

Coldness and solitude are consequence, not choice.

MOVEMENT II Inside the Body *The senses, the storms, and the comfort of sameness*

05

When the Body Won't Obey

He's remote-controlling a body that won't listen.

06

A World of Too Much

The senses flood in, unfiltered and overwhelming.

07

The Tsunami

Meltdowns are a flood of feeling, not a tantrum.

08

The Comfort of Sameness

Unchanging things are handrails in a chaotic world.

09

Semi-Detached From Time

He can't feel time pass, so the next moment worries him.

MOVEMENT III The Reason I Jump *The inner life, and the plea for hope*

10

Why I Jump

Feelings too big for the body, sent up to the sky.

11

Green Is Life

Nature gives him permission to be alive.

12

Would You Like to Be Normal?

Self-acceptance matters more than a cure.

13

I'm Right Here

Present even when he can't reach you. Hold onto hope.

“So long as there's hope, we can stick at it.”

NAOKI HIGASHIDA

How to Be With Him

Naoki's own requests — to pin on a wall or keep in a notebook.

CONNECT

How to reach him

- **Say his name first**
then speak — a voice alone won't register.
- **Give him time**
and don't stack new questions on top.
- **Talk to his real age**
never baby-talk; protect his self-respect.
- **Words may not match meaning**
a spoken “yes” isn't proof of yes.
- **Never laugh at halting speech**
the effort behind each word is enormous.
- **Talk the day through out loud**
rather than a rigid picture schedule.

STEADY

When the world is too much

- **In a meltdown, stay close**
keep him safe; let the flood pass.
- **Let a flashback cry itself out**
old feelings hit like a sudden storm.
- **Cue the next action**
a quiet “go ahead” is the green light.
- **Stop only harmful obsessions**
leave the harmless ones be; they pass.
- **Let him filter the world**
cupped ears and softened light are fine.
- **Take him into nature**
green and water recharge his whole system.
- **Don't punish sleeplessness**
the cure, he found, is often just time.

KEEP FAITH

The standing posture

- **Never give up on him**
being watched over makes him stronger.
- **Don't let stress become despair**
it saps the spirit he needs to go on.
- **Believe there's a full mind inside**
he takes in far more than he can show.
- **He wants company, not solitude**
keep including him — always.
- **Hold onto hope — out loud**
his future is bound up with yours.